

•••CORIOLIS•••

RULES

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CONTENTS

Rules	2
Combat	5
Skills.	6
Characteristics	7
Travel Times	8
Probabilities	8
Training	8
Mystic Talents	9

Traveller is a tabletop role-playing game where you explore the galaxy, tackle challenges, and shape an epic sci-fi story. This guide covers the basics to help you get started quickly.

THE BASICS

- **Referee (GM):** The Game Master sets the scenes, plays NPCs, presents challenges, and resolves outcomes. They guide the story based on player choices.
- **Players:** You control Travellers—spacefaring characters who respond to the GM's scenarios. Your decisions shape the story.
- **Skill Checks:** Roll dice when you're unsure an action will succeed and it might change what happens next.

SKILL CHECKS

Follow these steps for a Skill Check:

- **Roll 2D6:** Roll two six-sided dice.
- **Add Die Modifiers:** Your rank in the relevant skill, or -3 if you don't have it. Plus a bonus or penalty from the most relevant characteristic (e.g., STR, DEX, INT).
- **Compare to Target Number:** Add your roll, skill level, and stat modifier. If the total meets or exceeds the target number, the action succeeds. Otherwise, it fails. Routine (6+), Average (8+), Difficult (10+). Standard Difficulty: 8+.
- **Determine the Effect:** The difference between your roll (with modifiers) and the target number is called effect.
Positive Effect: Exceeding the target means greater success or bonuses.
Negative Effect: Missing the target may lead to partial success or significant consequences.
- If a Traveller has no level in a skill at all, then they are untrained and suffer DM-3 when trying to use that skill.
- If a Traveller has zero level in a skill (Skill 0), then they are competent in using that skill but don't have much experience with it. They do not get any bonus and avoid the penalty for being untrained.
- If a Traveller has one or more levels in a skill (Skill 1, Skill 2, ...) then they are trained in that skill. Each level represents years of experience using that skill and grants DM+1 per level to all skill checks using that skill.

BOONS AND BANES

Use when conditions significantly help or hinder actions.

- **Boon:** Roll 3D6, keep the highest two. Used when circumstances are favorable—having the right tools, extra help, or ideal conditions.
- **Bane:** Roll 3D6, keep the lowest two. Used when conditions are poor—working under pressure, lacking gear, or being injured.

EFFECTS

EFFECT	RESULT
-6 or less	Exceptional Failure: The Traveller failed as completely as it is possible to fail. Anything that can go wrong goes wrong. If attempting to repair a device, the device is further damaged or even destroyed. In a social situation, the Traveller gets into further trouble.
-2 to -5	Average Failure: The Traveller has failed the task.
-1	Marginal Failure: The Traveller has almost succeeded and the referee may permit them to scrape a success if they take a significant consequence. A Traveller trying to jump across a chasm hangs onto the far side by their fingernails but can only pull themselves up if they drop their backpack. A Traveller trying to land a ship can bring it down safely but the ship may never fly again. A Traveller hacking a computer gets in but the security programs can trace their location.
0	Marginal Success: The Traveller barely succeeds at the task and may have to accept a condition on their success. They fix the engine but it will overheat. They find a buyer for the goods but the buyer is an untrustworthy criminal.
1 to 5	Average Success: The Traveller succeeds normally.
6 or more	Exceptional Success: The Traveller succeeds in an impressive and elegant fashion.

OPPOSED CHECKS

If two or more Travellers are opposing one another directly in a task or if a Traveller is directly opposing another character, an opposed check is made. Both Travellers or characters make their task checks as normal, with the winner being the one with the highest Effect.

TASK CHAINS

Often, Travellers will find themselves performing a series of interlinked tasks or working as a group. When tasks are linked together like this they are called task chains and the result of one check can give a DM to the next – for better or worse. The DM gleaned from one check and then applied to the next is shown on the Task Chain table.

PREVIOUS CHECK	DM TO CURRENT CHECK
Failed with effect -6 or less	-3
Failed with effect -2 to -5	-2
Failed with effect -1	-1
Succeeded with effect 0	+1
Succeeded with effect 1 to 5	+2
Succeeded with effect 6 or more	+3

WORKING TOGETHER

Task chains usually assume that while Travellers are working together, they are waiting for the results of one check in order to affect the next. However, there will be times when Travellers are working at the same time on exactly the same task and will wish to combine their efforts.

In these situations, the task chain rules can still be used but with one Traveller making the 'final' check and the others making checks to add task chain modifiers.

TIPS FOR NEW PLAYERS

- **Work Together:** Traveller is a team game— cooperation is key to survival.
- **Ask Questions:** Don't hesitate to ask the GM for help or clarification.
- **Be Creative:** Unconventional ideas often lead to the most memorable moments.

HEALING

UNCONSCIOUSNESS

Time: 1 minute

Effect: Average (8+) END check. A cumulative DM+1 applies for each roll after the first. If successful consciousness is recovered (setting END to 1).

FIRST AID

Requirements: Must be initiated within one minute of the injury occurring.

Time: 1D-2 rounds (min. 1 round)

Skill: Average (8+) Medicurgy check (EDU).

Effect: The patient regains lost characteristic points equal to the Effect. Split between attributes as desired. Can be supported with Medkits/Trauma Kits and/or M-doses/T-doses. Can be self applied if not unconscious. Only once after receiving an injury.

MEDICAL CARE

Requirements: A hospital or medical bay. Full bed rest. Only 1 or 2 Physical Characteristics can be damaged.

Time: 1 day

Skill: no check needed

Effect: Heal physical Characteristic points equal to: 3 + END DM + Doctor's Medicurgy DM, divided evenly between damaged physical Characteristics. Medkits/Traumkits/m-doses/t-doses can be used.

SURGERY

Requirements: Requires a hospital or medical bay.

Time: 1D hours

Skill: Average 8+ Medicurgy (EDU).

Effect: Heal physical Characteristic points equal to: Medicurgy check Effect +3, split between attributes as desired. Medkits/Traumkits/m-doses/t-doses can be used. Failure causes further injury equal to the Effect.

NATURAL HEALING

Requirements: Full Rest.

Time: 1 day

Effect: Heal physical Characteristic points equal to: 1D + END DM divided evenly between damaged physical Characteristics. If three Characteristics are damaged this healing is reduced to only the END DM (may result in further damage).

MENTAL CHARACTERISTIC HEALING

Time: 1 day

Effect: Heal one point per Mental Characteristic.

AUGMENTATION

Augmented Travellers in low-tech hospitals suffer a penalty to Medicurgy checks equal to the difference between tech levels.

KEY TERMS

- **Boon / Bane:** Roll 3D6 instead of 2. Boon uses the best two dice; Bane uses the worst two.
- **DM (Die Modifier):** A bonus or penalty applied to a roll, usually from a skill, stat, or situational factor.
- **Effect:** The difference between your total roll and the target number (positive = success, zero = marginal success, negative = failure).
- **NPCs:** Non-Player Characters controlled by the GM— everyone in the universe who isn't a player.
- **Referee (GM):** The Game Master who guides the adventure, runs the universe, and adjudicates the rules.
- **Re-roll tokens:** Players may gain re-roll tokens and can have a maximum amount of these tokens as they have re-roll slots. Spend 1 re-roll token to re-roll any of your or any other player's dice roll (including table rolls). You choose either the new or the old result. Only one re-roll per test/table roll. You can't re-roll GM rolls. At the start of each session, you gain 1 re-roll token (if there is a free slot available). The GM may reward additional tokens.
- **Skill Check:** Roll to determine whether your character succeeds at a risky, challenging, or important action.
- **Target Number:** The score you need to succeed (Routine = 6+, Average = 8+, Difficult = 10+). If no target number is given, the default is always 8+.
- **Traveller:** Your character navigating the Horizon in search of fortune, purpose, or survival.

CAREER OPTIONS

PRE-CAREER EDUCATION

- **University**
- **Military Academy**
- **Colonial Upbringing**
- **Merchant Academy**
- **Mystic Community**
- **Slum "Education"**
- **Spacer Community**
- **Medical Academy**

CAREERS

- **Agent:** Law Enforcer, Intelligence, Consortium
- **Bounty Hunter:** Skip Tracer, Repossessor, Support
- **Citizen:** Consortium, Deckhand, Colonist
- **Clergy:** Draconite, Monastic, Preacher
- **Colonial Agent:** Courier, Surveyor, Explorer
- **Companion:** Qiran, Geisha, Pimp
- **Entertainer:** Artist, Journalist, Performer
- **Field Researcher:** Archaeologist, Planetologist, Terraformer
- **Merchant:** Merchant Marine, Free League, Broker
- **Noble:** Administrator, Diplomat, Dilettante
- **Politician:** Legislator, Apparatchik, Technocrat
- **Privateer:** Command, Deckhand, Mercenary
- **Rogue:** Thief, Enforcer, Pirate
- **Scholar:** Professor, Scientist, Physician

MILITARY CAREERS

- **Army:** Support, Infantry, Cavalry
- **Marine:** Support, Star Marine, Ground Assault
- **Navy:** Line/Crew, Engineer/Gunner, Flight

SPECIAL CAREERS

- **Drifter:** Wandering Circus, Trailblazer, Scavenger
Usually not actively chosen. You may enter Drifter after a mishap or due to life events.
- **Mystic:** Wild Talent, Adept, Mystic Warrior
Certain events may allow to follow this career. Or you could actively choose it - but entry costs **100.000**.
- **Prisoner:** Inmate, Thug, Fixer
Usually not actively chosen. You may enter Prisoner after a mishap or due to life events.

ENVIRONMENTAL DANGERS

FALLING

Reduce the metres fallen by the Effect of an Athletics Check. Damage is reduced by half of your Armour Protection.

Normal Gravity World: 1D damage per 2m.

High Gravity World: Increase 1D for every 4m.

Low Gravity World: Decrease 1D for every 4m.

FATIGUE

A Fatigued Traveller suffers a Bane to all checks until he rests. Fatigue occurs.

- After staying awake for hours greater than END + 18.
- After performing heavy labour for hours greater than END.
- After making a number of consecutive melee attacks greater than his END in a single combat.

GRAVITY

High G: DM-1 to all skill checks until acclimatised (1D weeks or automatic with Athletics STR skill).

Low G: DM-1 to all skill checks until acclimatised (1D weeks or automatic with Athletics DEX skill).

Zero G: As with Low, and using weapons without Zero-G Trait requires Athletics DEX 8+ check or miss and spin out of control. Regain control with Athletics DEX 8+ check.

SUFFOCATION

Without life support 1D damage/min.

Without air 1D damage/round.

WEATHER

Bad weather inflicts DM-1 to all skill checks.

VACUUM

Cumulative 1D damage every round (eg. 1 = 1D, 2 = 2D, 3 = 3D) + Radiation.

RADIATION

Radiation can have both immediate and long term cumulative effects. See tables on the right.

Minor reactor leak: 2D/hour

Serious reactor leak: 2D/10 minutes

Minor solar flare: 1D x 100/hour

Major solar flare: 3D x 100/hour

Radiation weapon: 2D x 20 immediately

IMMEDIATE RADIATION EXPOSURE

IMMEDIATE EFFECT

<= 50 rads	-
51 - 150 rads	1D damage (AP), nausea (DM -1 to all checks until medical treatment)
151 - 300 rads	2D damage (AP), nausea (DM -1 to all checks until medical treatment)
301 - 500 rads	4D damage (AP), nausea (DM -1 to all checks until medical treatment), hair loss
501 - 800 rads	6D damage (AP), extreme nausea (DM -2 to all checks until medical treatment), hair loss, sterile
> 800 rads	8D damage (AP), internal bleeding (DM -3 to all checks until medical treatment), hair loss, sterile

CUMMULATIVE RADIATION EXPOSURE

CUMMULATIVE EFFECT

<= 50 rads	-
51 - 150 rads	-
151 - 300 rads	-1 END permanently
301 - 500 rads	-2 END permanently
501 - 800 rads	-3 END permanently
> 800 rads	-4 END permanently

LUCK (LCK)

Luck represents a Traveller's general good and bad fortunes, and governs situations that are essentially beyond a Traveller's control. Luck may represent the Icon's protecting hands over the character or fate or literally just luck. LCK is determined by a straight 2D roll and cannot be permanently increased or decreased in the manner of a Travellers' other characteristics. Only major events can change a Travellers' LCK; this is at the discretion of the GM, who must decide what factors may influence LCK.

RANDOM SITUATIONS

LCK can be used to see what happens to which Traveller when no other factors apply. For example, if one Traveller selected at random is to be the victim of a bad event, everyone can make an opposed LCK check and the lowest score will be the victim. Some events will instead affect every Traveller failing a LCK check.

ALTERING CHANCES OF SUCCESS

If a Traveller really needs to succeed in a skill or characteristic check, they may expend LCK on a temporary basis. Each point of LCK spent translates into DM+1 to the check. Luck can be spent for allies or yourself. Likewise, each LCK point expended can be used as a negative DM to a check made against them; a Traveller can use LCK to make an enemy miss an otherwise easy shot. All LCK points expended in this way are regained at the end of an adventure.

SURVIVING A DISASTER

When a Traveller suffers some catastrophic event the GM may grant the Traveller a chance to survive through blind luck by a Very Difficult (12+) check, with no characteristic DMs used. Instead, the chances of survival can be increased by permanently expending points from the Traveller's LCK characteristic. A DM equal to the number of LCK points expended can be applied. Once these points are expended, they are gone for good. If the LCK check is successful, the Traveller somehow survives. If LCK reaches 0 then every random bad event that can possibly happen will befall the Traveller and their life may not be worth living. The GM should feel free to torment the unlucky individual as much as they please.

THE COMBAT ROUND

Each round lasts 6 seconds of game time. Actions Per Round:

- **1 Significant Action** (e.g., attack, first aid) **OR** **2 Minor Actions** instead of a Significant Action.
- **+ 1 Minor Action** (e.g., move, aim, reload).
- **+ Free Actions:** Simple actions (e.g., shouting, pushing a button) that take no time. You can take multiple per round if reasonable.

INITIATIVE

Roll $2D6 + DEX$ or INT modifier. Your Effect (against difficulty 0) is your Initiative score — higher goes first.

Ties: Higher DEX acts first; if still tied, resolve actions simultaneously.

SIGNIFICANT ACTIONS

Attack:

- Declare target and roll the appropriate skill check.
- Target may make a Reaction if desired (see below).
- Success: Roll $8+$ to hit, deal damage.

Leadership:

- Make a (INT/EDU/SOC) Leadership check if able to freely communicate to at least one ally.
- Effect > 0 : Effect defines the number of DM+1 bonuses the character can give to allies (max. 1 per ally) that can hear the commands.
- Effect < 0 : Opponents impose DM-1 penalties to your team for 1 round (number of times equals negative Effect).

Miscellaneous:

- Apply first aid, use mystic powers, bypass a security system, or complete other tasks requiring full attention.

MINOR ACTIONS

- **Move:** Travel up to your Movement score (typically 6m for humans).
- **Aim:** Spend one action aiming to gain DM+1 to your next attack (up to DM+6 if aiming consecutively).
- **Change Stance:** Stand, crouch, or lie prone.
- **Draw/Reload:** Ready or reload a weapon.
- **Miscellaneous:** Perform quick tasks like picking up items or spotting cover.

AMBUSHES

- Surprised Side: DM-6 to Initiative in the first round.
- Ambushing Side: DM+6 to Initiative in the first round.

REACTIONS

A Traveller may react when attacked (any number of times).

- **Dive for Cover:** Apply DM-2 to all incoming ranged attacks. Requires cover. You lose your next actions. May be negated if attackers reposition or attack from side or rear (GM decision).
- **Dodge:** In close or ranged combat use DEX DM or Athletics [dexterity] DM to reduce the attacker's roll. Adds DM-1 to your next actions. Each single attack must be dodged separately.
- **Parry:** In close combat, use Melee skill as a negative DM against an attacker's melee attack. No roll needed. Adds DM-1 to your next actions.

RANGED COMBAT

Ranged Attack: $2D6 + \text{Gun Combat} + DEX \text{ DM}$.

Some ranged weapons will use a skill other than Gun Combat. A rocket launcher will use Heavy Weapons [portable], while grenades and any other weapons that are thrown will use Athletics [dexterity].

Range: This is the effective range of a weapon, the range at which an average user has a good chance of hitting a target. The maximum range of a weapon is the next range band - with a DM of -3. Further than that, the weapon can't hit a target. Ranges attacks have a DM of +1 in Close range (but not in Melee, see below).

Range Bands:

RANGE	DISTANCE
Personal	Touch or less than 1m
Close	up to 5m
Short	up to 10m
Medium	up to 50m
Long	up to 250m
Very long	up to 500m
Distant	up to 5km
Very distant	up to 500km
Continental	up to 5.000km
Planetary	up to 50.000km

Ranged Damage: Roll the weapon's damage and add the Effect of the attack roll.

Melee: If you are in Personal Range with your opponent(s), you are considered to be in melee. Rifles can't be fired in melee—only used as clubs or to parry. Pistols can be fired, but may be parried (see Reactions).

MELEE COMBAT

Melee Attack: $2D6 + \text{Melee} + STR \text{ or } DEX \text{ DM}$.

Melee Damage: Roll the weapon's damage and add the Effect of the attack roll and your STR DM.

DAMAGE RULES

- Health = END + STR + DEX

APPLYING DAMAGE

- Subtract damage from END first. Once END is 0, apply excess damage to STR or DEX (player's choice). Reducing both STR and DEX makes healing harder.
- Unconscious if END is 0 and either STR or DEX is also 0.
- Dead if all three—STR, DEX, and END—are reduced to 0.

LOWERING STATS AND MODIFIERS

- As STR, DEX, or END are reduced by damage, their associated DMs decrease. Always use the current modifier when making skill checks or rolls.
- **Armor:** Reduces damage by its Protection score.
- **Minimum Damage:** Attacks with Effect 6+ always deal at least 1 damage, regardless of Protection.
- **Armor Piercing (AP):** Ignores an amount of Protection equal to the weapon's AP score.

COMBAT TIPS FOR NEW PLAYERS

- **Take Cover:** Use Minor Actions to position yourself behind cover and avoid damage.
- **Plan Ahead:** Use teamwork and tactics like Leadership to turn the tide.
- **Know Your Limits:** Combat is deadly—don't rush in.

ADMIN

This skill covers bureaucracies and administration of all sorts, including the navigation of bureaucratic obstacles or disasters. It also covers tracking inventories, ship manifests and other records.

ADVOCATE

Advocate gives a knowledge of common legal codes and practises, especially interstellar law. It also gives the Traveller experience in oratory, debate and public speaking, making it an excellent skill for lawyers and politicians.

ANIMALS

This skill, rare on industrialised or technologically advanced worlds, is for the care of animals.

Specialties: Handling, Veterinary, Training

ART

The Traveller is trained in a type of creative art.

Specialties: Performer, Holography, Instrument, Visual Media, Write

ASTROGATION

This skill is for plotting the courses of starships and calculating accurate jumps.

ATHLETICS

The Traveller is a trained athlete and is physically fit. The Athletics skill effectively augments a Traveller's physical characteristics.

Specialties: *Dexterity* (Climbing, Juggling, Throwing, Sprinting, High Jumping, Long Jumping), *Endurance* (Long-distance running, hiking Long-distance Running, Long-distance Swimming), *Strength* (Feats of strength, weight-lifting)

BROKER

The Broker skill allows a Traveller to negotiate trades and arrange fair deals. It is heavily used when trading.

CAROUSE

Carousing is the art of socialising; having fun, but also ensuring other people have fun, and infectious good humour. It also covers social awareness and subterfuge in such situations.

CULTURE

Knowledge of the cultures, factions, rituals and humanites of the Third Horizon.

DECEPTION

Deception allows a Traveller to lie fluently, disguise themselves, perform sleight of hand and fool onlookers. Most underhanded ways of cheating and lying fall under deception.

DIPLOMAT

The Diplomat skill is for negotiating deals, establishing peaceful contact and smoothing over social faux pas. It includes how to behave in high society and proper ways to address nobles. It is a much more formal skill than Persuade.

DRIVE

This skill is for controlling ground vehicles of various types. There are several specialties.

Specialties: Hovercraft, Mole, Track, Walker, Wheel

DATADJINN

This skill is used to operate electronic devices such as computers and ship-board systems. Higher levels represent the ability to repair and create electronic devices and systems. There are several specialties.

Specialties: Comms, Computers, Remote Ops, Sensors

ENGINEER

The Engineer skill is used to operate and maintain spacecraft and advanced vehicles. Engineer can be used to make repairs on damaged systems on spacecraft and advanced vehicles. For repairs on simpler machines and systems, use the Mechanic skill.

Specialties: M-drive, J-drive, Life Support, Power

EXPLOSIVES

The Explosives skill covers the use of demolition charges and other explosive devices, including assembling or disarming bombs. A failed Explosives check with an Effect of -4 or less can result in a bomb detonating prematurely.

FLYER

The various specialties of this skill cover different types of flying vehicles. Flyers only work in an atmosphere; vehicles that can leave the atmosphere and enter orbit generally use the Pilot skill.

Specialties: Airship, Grav, Ornithopter, Rotor, Wing

GAMBLER

The Traveller is familiar with a wide variety of gambling games, such as tawla, roulette, blackjack, camel-racing, sports betting (like sijjada) and so on, and has an excellent grasp of statistics and probability. Increases the rewards from Benefit rolls, giving the Traveller DM+1 to their cash rolls if they have Gambler 1 or better.

GUNNER

The various specialties of this skill deal with the operation of ship-mounted weapons in space combat. Most Travellers have smaller ships equipped solely with turret weapons.

Specialties: Turret, Ortilery, Screen, Capital

GUN COMBAT

The Gun Combat skill covers a variety of ranged weapons. See the Combat chapter for details on using guns in combat.

Specialties: *Archaic* (Bows, Slings), *Energy* (Laser, Meson), *Slug* (Ballistic, Accelerator, Thermal, Grape), *Propelled* (Vulcan, Plasma)

HEAVY WEAPONS

The Heavy Weapons skill covers portable and larger weapons that cause extreme property damage, such as rocket launchers, artillery and large plasma weapons.

Specialties: Artillery, Portable, Vehicle

INVESTIGATE

The Investigate skill incorporates keen observation, forensics and detailed analysis.

JACK-OF-ALL-TRADES

The Jack-of-All-Trades skill works differently to other skills. It reduces the unskilled penalty a Traveller receives for not having the appropriate skill by one for every level of Jack-of-All-Trades. There is no benefit for having Jack-of-All-Trades 0 or 4+.

LANGUAGE

There are numerous different Language specialties, each one covering reading and writing in a different language. All Travellers can speak and read their native language without needing the Language skill and automated computer translator programs mean Language skills are not always needed on other worlds. Having Language 0 implies the Traveller has a smattering of simple phrases in a few common languages.

Specialties: Core (common trade language of the Third Horizon), Traidtional (language understood by most Firstcome), Dabari (from Dabaran), Nektra (Nektara language), and many more

LEADERSHIP

The Leadership skill is for directing, inspiring and rallying allies and comrades. A Traveller may make a Leadership action in combat.

MECHANIC

The Mechanic skill allows a Traveller to maintain and repair most equipment – some advanced equipment and spacecraft components require the Engineer skill. Unlike the narrower and more focused Engineer or Science skills, Mechanic does not allow a Traveller to build new devices or alter existing ones – it is purely for repairs and maintenance but covers all types of equipment.

MEDICURGY

The Medicurgy skill covers emergency first aid and battlefield triage as well as diagnosis, treatment, surgery and long-term care.

MELEE

The Melee skill covers attacking in hand-to-hand combat and the use of suitable weapons.

Specialities: Unarmed, Blade, Bludgeon, Natural

MYSTICISM

Knowledge about the history of the portal builders, creature of the Darkness between the stars and typical mental powers.

Specialities: Darkness between the Stars, Portal Builders, Mystic Powers

NAVIGATION

Navigation is the planetside counterpart of astrogation, covering plotting courses and finding directions on the ground.

PERSUADE

Persuade is a more casual, informal version of Diplomat. It covers fast talking, bargaining, wheedling and bluffing. It also covers bribery or intimidation.

PILOT

The Pilot skill specialities cover different forms of spacecraft.

Specialities: Small Craft, Spacecraft, Capital Ships

PROFESSION

A Traveller with a Profession skill is trained in producing useful goods or services. The Traveller can make a Profession check to earn money on a planet that supports that trade. The amount of money raised is **B**• 250 x the Effect of the check per month. Unlike other skills with specialties, levels in the Profession skill do not grant the ability to use other specialties at level 0. Each specialty must be learned individually. Someone with a Profession skill of 0 has a general grasp of working for a living but little experience beyond the most menial jobs. There are a huge range of potential specialties for this skill.

Specialities: Belter, Biologicals, Civil Engineering, Construction, Hydroponics, Polymers, Colonist, Crewmember, Freeloader, Sport, and many more

RECON

A Traveller trained in Recon is able to scout out dangers and spot threats, unusual objects or out of place people.

SCIENCE

The Science skill covers not just knowledge but also practical application of that knowledge where such practical application is possible. There are a large range of specialties.

Specialities: Archaeology, Astronomy, Biology, Chemistry, Cosmology, Cybernetics, Economics, Genetics, History, Linguistics, Philosophy, Physics, Planetology, Psychology, Robotics, Sophontology (study of intelligent living creatures), Xenology

SEAFARER

The Seafarer skill covers all manner of watercraft and ocean travel.

Specialities: Ocean Ships, Personal, Sail, Submarine

STEALTH

A Traveller trained in the Stealth skill is adept at staying unseen, unheard and unnoticed.

STEWARD

The Steward skill allows the Traveller to serve and care for nobles and high-class passengers. It covers everything from proper address and behaviour to cooking and tailoring, as well as basic management skills. A Traveller with the Steward skill is necessary on any ship offering high or luxury passage.

STREETWISE

A Traveller with the Streetwise skill understands the urban environment and the power structures in society. On their homeworld, and in related systems, they know criminal contacts and fixers. On other worlds, they can quickly intuit power structures and fit into local underworlds.

SURVIVAL

The Survival skill is the wilderness counterpart of the urban Streetwise skill – the Traveller is trained to survive in the wild, build shelters, hunt or trap animals, avoid exposure and so forth. They can recognise plants and animals of their homeworld and related planets and can pick up on common clues and traits even on unfamiliar worlds.

TACTICS

This skill covers tactical planning and decision making, from board games to squad level combat to fleet engagements. For use in combat, see Combat chapter.

Specialities: Military, Naval

VACC SUIT

The Vacc Suit skill allows a Traveller to wear and operate spacesuits and environmental suits. A Traveller will rarely need to make Vacc Suit checks under ordinary circumstances – merely possessing the skill is enough. If the Traveller does not have the requisite Vacc Suit skill for the suit they are wearing, they suffer DM-1 to all skill checks made while wearing a suit for each missing level. This skill also permits a Traveller to operate advanced battle armour.

CHARACTERISTICS

■ PHYSICAL CHARACTERISTICS

STRENGTH (STR)

Physical strength, fitness and forcefulness.

DEXTERITY (DEX)

Physical co-ordination and agility, reflexes.

ENDURANCE (END)

Stamina, determination and ability to sustain damage.

■ MENTAL CHARACTERISTICS

INTELLECT (INT)

Intelligence and quickness of mind.

EDUCATION (EDU)

A measure of learning and experience.

SOCIAL STANDING (SOC)

Place in society, Charisma.

■ OTHER CHARACTERISTICS

REPUTATION (REP)

Reputation is, at its core, a measure of professional competency. But also how recognizable you are. Can give a modifier to certain social interactions. Starts at 0 (Zero).

MYSTIC STRENGTH INDEX (MSI)

How good you are with Mystic Powers. Only determined if life path says so. Has special rules: gives access to psionic skills.

LUCK (LCK)

Protection by the Icons, fate, simple luck. Has special rules: may be used to support checks or even cheat death. Determined like the other base characteristics.

TRAVEL TIMES

■ INTERPLANETARY TRAVEL

The time it takes to travel 1 AU is depending on the Thrust rating of your m-drive:

M-DRIVE THRUST	1 AU TRAVEL DURATION
1	48h
2	36h
3	24h
4	16h
5	12h
6	10h
7	8h
8	6h
9	5h

■ INTERSTELLAR TRAVEL

■ PORTAL JUMPS

Portal jumps are near instant, but waiting for a slot, the calculation, tariff controls, etc. take hours.

TRAVEL AS...	WAIT	DURATION	COST
Single ship, high computer	2D6m	about 10s	► 250
Single ship, low computer	1D3h	about 10s	► 4.000
Part of a convoy	2D6h	about 10s	► 1.500
Cargo in a bulk hauler	6D6h + 1D3h	about 10s	► 2.500

■ JUMP DRIVES

Regardless of the distance travelled, the jump always takes 1 week (nine days). The route must be calculated before jumping, which can take several minutes.

PROBABILITIES

DIFFICULTY	DM-5	DM-4	DM-3	DM-2	DM-1	0	DM+1	DM+2	DM+3	DM+4	DM+5
Easy (4+)	28%	42%	58%	72%	83%	92%	97%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Routine (6+)	8%	17%	28%	42%	58%	72%	83%	92%	97%	100%	100%
Average (8+)	0%	3%	8%	17%	28%	42%	58%	72%	83%	92%	97%
Difficult (10+)	0%	0%	0%	3%	8%	17%	28%	42%	58%	72%	83%
Very difficult (12+)	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	3%	8%	17%	28%	42%	58%
Formidable (14+)	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	3%	8%	17%	28%
Impossible (16+)	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	3%	8%

TRAINING

■ EXPERIENCE

At certain points in the story, the GM will allow the group to spend Experience Points, usually after some major story event, and when the characters have free time for training.

■ GAINING EXPERIENCE POINTS

After each session, all Travellers will gain 1 automatic experience point. Great roleplay and completed story arcs will earn them additional points (GM discretion).

■ INCREASING SKILLS

New Skill: To gain a skill at level 0 costs 1 Experience point.

Training existing skills: Gaining level 1 from level 0 costs 1. After that the cost is doubled, as shown on the following table. Each skill level must be bought in turn.

The cost is reduced if the skill has been used since the last training point. Mark the checkbox near a skill if you either succeeded in a check with effect 5+ or failed a check. Only one mark can be made per skill.

SKILL LEVEL	COST	COST REDUCED
1	2	1
2	4	2
3	6	4
4	9	7
5	15	12
6*	30	26
7*	60	50

■ INCREASING CHARACTERISTICS

Physical and mental characteristics may also be increased by appropriate activity. Gym work, sport and general exertion are good for physical characteristics (STR, END and DEX) while study and problem-solving can be used to train the mind (INT and EDU). SOC cannot be trained; a Traveller who wants to improve his SOC will have to do it in-game and spend a lot of Birr in the process. LCK can not be raised.

To increase a physical characteristic, the cost in Experience points is shown here:

NEW CHARACTERISTIC VALUE	COST STR, DEX, END	COST INT, EDU
1	1	2
2	2	4
3	3	5
4	4	6
5	5	8
6	6	10
7	7	12
8	8	15
9	9	18
10	10	20
11	12	22
12	14	24
13	16	26
14	18	28
15	20	30
16*	24	34

Mystics are very rare and not an official option during character creation. Childhood and Life events can lead you to a mystic community, where you can train your mystic talents. During your adventures you may discover your mystic abilities of the GM allows it. The most common talents are:

- **Mind Reading:** communicating & detecting
- **Clairvoyance:** Perceiving at a distance
- **Telekinesis:** Mind over matter
- **Bodycraft:** Positive control over one's body
- **Wandering the Void:** Moving from one point to another instantly

USING MYSTIC POWERS

To activate a power, the Traveller must make a skill check using the appropriate skill (Telepathy, Telekinesis and so on), adding their MSI DM, along with any other appropriate DMs. They must also spend the listed number of MSI points if they succeed or one point if they fail. If this cost brings them below zero MSI, then any excess points are applied as damage. A Traveller with no MSI points cannot attempt to activate a power.

Most powers can be used at a distance and have a Reach characteristic. This is the distance at which the power can normally be used. However, a strong mystic can increase the range at which they use powers with greater mental effort: The Reach of a power can be increased by one Range Band if twice the MSI cost is paid.

Expend PSI points are recovered at the rate of one point per hour, beginning three hours after the Traveller last used a psionic talent.

MIND READING

Mind Reading is the talent of mind-to-mind contact. It is normally subtle by nature but can be used to bluntly crush the wills of those who oppose the telepath.

LIFE DETECTION

The most elementary form of mind reading is the ability to detect the presence of other minds. Life detection enables a Traveller to sense the presence of other minds, the number of minds present, the general type of minds (animal, human and so on) and their approximate location. Life detection is reasonably sophisticated and can distinguish intelligent beings from bacteria or unimportant animals in the area. It functions best in detecting intelligent minds. Shielded minds are undetectable. If an individual whom the telepath knows is detected using this power, they will be recognised.

Check: Easy (4+) Telepathy check (1D x 10 seconds, MSI)

Reach: Distant

MSI Cost: 1

MIND LINK

This power is used by mind readers to communicate with one another – but not with mundanes. Both mind readers must use this power for it to work but once this is done, they may communicate silently with one another for a number of minutes equal to the combined Effects of their Mind Reading checks.

Check: Easy (4+) Mind Reading check (1D seconds, MSI)

Reach: Distant

MSI Cost: 1

OPEN EMOTIONS

The communication of emotions and basic feelings is accomplished by this talent. It serves well in the handling of animals but may also be applied as a psychological weapon against sophonts. Sending of emotions such as love, hate, fear and others may influence other beings (although not necessarily in the manner desired). The Effect of the Mind Reading check is used to judge the strength of the emotion projected. Open Emotions also allows the emotions and feelings of others to be read. Other Mind Readers will always recognise when someone is using Open Emotions to bend their emotions but others will not. The change in mood may be dramatic and inexplicable but most will simply ascribe it to the mercurial nature of human emotions.

Check: Routine (6+) Mind Reading check (1D x 10 seconds, MSI)

Reach: Long

MSI Cost: 1

READ SURFACE THOUGHTS

The most commonly known feature of Mind Reading is the ability to read the thoughts of other individuals. Only active and current thoughts are read by this ability, with the subject (if themselves not a mind reader) unaware of the activity. Individuals with Mind Reading ability cannot be read due to the presence of their natural shields, unless they willingly lower their shielding. The Effect of the check determines the clarity of the mind reader's perceptions.

Check: Average (8+) Mind Reading check (1D x 10 seconds, MSI)

Reach: Long

MSI Cost: 2

SEND THOUGHTS

Complementary to the ability to read surface thoughts is the power to send thoughts to others. Such individuals need not be mystics themselves to receive such thoughts. Mind Readers are normally open to such transmissions but may close their shields against them if they become bothersome or threatening.

Check: Difficult (10+) Mind Reading check (1D x 10 seconds, MSI)

Reach: Distant

MSI Cost: 2

ASSAULT

Violence may be dealt by a Mind Reader. An unshielded mind, when assaulted by mind reading, is rendered unconscious immediately and causes Effect x 3 damage. When a shielded mind is assaulted, the two mind readers make opposed Mind Reading checks. If the attacker wins, the victim suffers damage.

Check: Formidable (14+) Mind Reading check (1D seconds, MSI)

Reach: Short

MSI Cost: 8

SHIELD

All mind readers learn how to create a mental shield, which protects the mind against unwanted mind reading interference. Such a shield is automatically in force at all times and requires no MSI expenditure to maintain but can be lowered to allow telepathic contact or use of telepathic powers.

CLAIRVOYANCE

Clairvoyance is a talent that allows a person to sense events at some location displaced from the viewer. There are several levels of clairvoyant ability. Clairvoyance powers allow eavesdropping activities as well as spying and detection-free exploration of situations. Clairvoyant activity cannot be sensed by others, including by other mystics.

TACTICAL AWARENESS

With this power, the Traveller can perceive dangers and foes around them using their clairvoyant abilities. This enhanced spatial perception allows them to ignore the effects of darkness, smoke, fog or other environmental effects that impede vision. They may also detect hidden foes within range. The Effect of the check determines the number of combat rounds the awareness lasts.

Check: Average (8+) Clairvoyance check (1D seconds, MSI)

Reach: Long

MSI Cost: 2

CLAIRVOYANCE

This specific power allows actual viewing of a situation at some displaced point. The clairvoyant Traveller must state the range at which they are applying this power. The Effect of the check determines the level of detail perceived.

Check: Average (8+) Clairvoyance check (1D x 10 seconds, MSI)

Reach: Very Distant

MSI Cost: 1

CLAIRAUDIENCE

This power is identical to clairvoyance, with the exception that it allows hearing instead of seeing.

Check: Average (8+) Clairvoyance check (1D x 10 seconds, MSI)

Reach: Very Distant

MSI Cost: 1

CLAIRSENTIENCE

A Traveller is capable of both seeing and hearing a specific situation by using this power.

Check: Difficult (10+) Clairvoyance check (1D x 10 seconds, MSI)

Reach: Very Distant

MSI Cost: 2

TELEKINESIS

Telekinesis is the talent that allows objects to be manipulated without physically touching them. Any manipulation is treated as if the Traveller was physically handling the item but physical danger, pain or other stimuli are not present. Telekinesis includes a limited amount of sensory awareness, sufficient to allow intelligent manipulation.

TELEKINESIS

This basic form of the talent allows the Traveller to move objects at range. The Effect of the check determines the duration of the telekinesis in combat rounds. The number of MSI points spent determines the mass that can be moved.

Check: Average (8+) Telekinesis check (1D seconds, MSI)

Reach: Short

MSI Cost: 1 per 10kg

FLIGHT

By applying telekinesis to their own body, the Traveller can fly, or at least levitate over short distances. The Traveller can fly for a number of rounds equal to the Effect of the check at a speed of 15 metres per round.

Check: Difficult (10+) Telekinesis check (1D seconds, MSI)

MSI Cost: 5

TELEKINETIC PUNCH

Telekinesis can be used as a direct attack, smashing the foe with a blast of telekinetic force. The damage inflicted is equal to the Effect. Protection from any armour is applied as normal.

Check: Average (8+) Telekinesis check (1D seconds, MSI)

Reach: Short

MSI Cost: 1

MICROKINESIS

This more challenging form of telekinesis allows for fine manipulation of very small or even microscopic objects. A telekinetic can use this power to pick locks, perform microsurgery, sabotage a computer system and so forth.

Check: Difficult (10+) Telekinesis check (1D x 10 seconds, MSI)

Reach: Close

MSI Cost: 3

BODYCRAFT

Bodycraft is the mystic talent that allows manipulation of one's own body and that of others. Bodycraft powers never have Reach – they are used only on the Traveller themselves or by touching the willing target.

SUSPENDED ANIMATION

Personal body activity may be suspended for varying periods of time. A Traveller with bodycraft may enter or induce a suspended animation state (similar to cold sleep but without the intrinsic danger of death). Such a state continues for seven days, without need for food or water and with minimal air needs. The Traveller could effectively travel in a cold sleep berth, without actually undergoing cold sleep and its dangers. Suspended animation may be stopped at any time, provided external stimulus is given to awaken the sleeper (such as a friend nudging them or a mechanical alarm).

Check: Average (8+) Bodycraft check (1D minutes, MSI)

MSI Cost: 3

FORTITUDE

By channelling mystic energy to the skeletal structure and boosting the healing rate, the Traveller can enhance the ability to absorb damage. Fortitude lasts a number of rounds equal to the Effect of the Awareness check and provides Protection equal to the number of MSI points expended. Fortitude stacks with worn armour.

Check: Difficult (10+) Bodycraft check (1D seconds, MSI)

MSI Cost: Amount of Armour

REGENERATION

Wounds may be healed by the application of this power, exchanging one MSI point to regenerate one lost characteristic point. Should one session of healing be insufficient, further healing and regeneration may be applied after expended MSI is recovered. Regeneration may also be applied to the growing of new limbs or organs to replace lost ones or to heal old wounds suffered prior to psionic training. Regeneration may not be used to counteract ageing, nor may it be used to regain lost SOC.

Check: Difficult (10+) Bodycraft check (1D x 10 seconds, MSI)

MSI Cost: Amount healed. If healing others: amount healed +2.

WANDERING THE VOID

Wandering the Void (sometimes called Teleportation) is a talent that allows effectively instantaneous movement from one point to another point, without regard to intervening matter.

TELEPORTATION

Teleportation is limited to the movement of the teleported Traveller's body and (for highly skilled Wanderers) their clothing and equipment.

Check: Average (8+) Wandering the Void check (1D seconds, MSI)

Reach: Distant

MSI Cost: 2

To teleport with clothing (but not armour) and up to 10kg of equipment, the Wandering the Void check is increased to Difficult (10+) and costs an additional 2 MSI.

To teleport with clothing (but not armour) and up to 500kg of equipment, the Wandering the Void check is increased to Very Difficult (12+) and costs an additional 4 MSI.

Wandering the Void always involves the movement of one's body to another location. Independent items or other individuals may not be moved. Teleportation involves certain requirements in order to be accurate and to ensure obedience of the laws of physics.

Pre-knowledge of Destination: A Traveller must always have a mental image of their destination before teleporting. This mental image is acquired by personally visiting the location first (this includes viewing it from a distance), having the mental image implanted in one's mind (via telepathy) by another person who has visited the destination or by viewing the location through clairvoyance.

Energy and Momentum: Wandering the Void involves serious restrictions on movement in order to ensure the conservation of energy and momentum, two laws of physics that can cause teleporting Travellers serious issues.

increase of 2.5°C; this is sufficient to cause extreme fever, brain damage and even death. A jump upwards will cool the body by the same amount, with equally serious results. To be safe, a jump may not involve an elevation change of more than 400 metres and multiple jumps should not involve a cumulative elevation change or more than 600 metres in one hour. These problems may be circumvented somewhat through the use of technological devices such as energy compensators, heated suits and other means. Travellers may feel driven to invent such materials, commission their invention or seek them out from those who already have them.

On planetary surfaces, teleportation is restricted to jumps of no more than Very Distant ranges. Jumps beyond visual range involve disorientation for a period of 2D – Effect of Wandering the Void check x 10 seconds.

This restriction results from the law of conservation of momentum; on a rotating planet, two locations will have different rotational speeds and directions. A jump from a point on the Earth's equator to its antipode would result in a total velocity difference between the Traveller and their surroundings of over 3,300 kilometres per hour.

Changes in altitude (actually all movement to locations of differing gravitational potential) will result in potential energy changes, manifesting themselves as alterations in body temperature. A jump of one kilometre straight down will result in an internal temperature